

PitchBook report methodologies

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Geographical groupings in research coverage

US regions:

- **West Coast:** Alaska, California, Hawaii, Oregon and Washington
- **Mountain:** Arizona, Colorado, Idaho, Montana, Nevada, New Mexico, Utah and Wyoming
- **Midwest:** Iowa, Kansas, Missouri, Nebraska, North Dakota and South Dakota
- **Great Lakes:** Illinois, Indiana, Michigan, Minnesota, Ohio and Wisconsin
- **New England:** Connecticut, Maine, Massachusetts, New Hampshire, Rhode Island and Vermont
- **Mid-Atlantic:** Delaware, DC, Maryland, New Jersey, New York, Pennsylvania, Virginia and West Virginia
- **South:** Arkansas, Kentucky, Louisiana, Oklahoma, Tennessee and Texas
- **Southeast:** Alabama, Florida, Georgia, Mississippi, North Carolina, Puerto Rico and South Carolina

EMEA regions:

- **UK & Ireland:** United Kingdom, Ireland and Channel Islands
- **Southern Europe:** Andorra, Cyprus, Gibraltar, Greece, Italy, Malta, Monaco, Portugal, San Marino and Spain
- **Nordics:** Denmark, Faroe Islands, Finland, Greenland, Iceland, Norway and Sweden
- **Israel**
- **France/Benelux:** France, Belgium, Netherlands and Luxembourg
- **DACH:** Germany, Switzerland and Austria
- **Central & Eastern Europe:** Albania, Belarus, Bosnia-Herzegovina, Bulgaria, Croatia, Czech Republic, Estonia, Hungary, Kosovo, Latvia, Lithuania, Macedonia, Moldova, Montenegro, Poland, Romania, Russia, Serbia, Slovakia, Slovenia and Ukraine
- **MENA:** Bahrain, Egypt, Iran, Jordan, Kuwait, Lebanon, Morocco, Oman, Saudi Arabia, Tunisia, Turkey, United Arab Emirates

APAC regions:

- **Greater China:** China, Hong Kong, Taiwan and Macau
- **Southeast Asia:** Brunei, Cambodia, East Timor, Indonesia, Laos, Malaysia, Myanmar, Philippines, Singapore, Thailand, Vietnam

Rest of world: Any region not demarcated in a given analysis or chart.

Benchmarks & fund performance

Fund classifications

Private equity

- Buyout
- Growth/expansion
- Restructuring/turnaround
- Diversified PE

Venture capital

Real estate

- Real estate core
- Real estate core plus
- Real estate value added
- Real estate opportunistic
- Real estate distressed

Real assets

- Infrastructure core
- Infrastructure core plus
- Infrastructure value added
- Infrastructure opportunistic
- Infrastructure greenfield
- Oil & gas
- Timber
- Metals/mining
- Agriculture

Private debt

- Direct lending
- Bridge financing
- Distressed debt
- Credit special situations
- Infrastructure debt
- Venture debt
- Real estate debt
- Mezzanine

Funds of funds

Secondaries

Data composition

PitchBook's fund returns data is primarily sourced from individual LP reports, serving as the baseline for our estimates of activity across an entire fund. For any given fund, return profiles will vary for LPs due to a range of factors, including fee discounts, timing of commitments and inclusion of co-investments. This granularity of LP-reported returns—all available on the PitchBook Platform—provides helpful insight to industry practitioners but results in discrepancies that must be addressed when calculating fund-level returns.

To be included in pooled calculations, a fund must have: (i) at least one LP report within two years of the fund's vintage, and (ii) LP reports in at least 45% of applicable reporting periods. To mitigate discrepancies among multiple LPs reporting, the PitchBook Benchmarks (iii) determine returns for each fund based on data from all LP reports in a given period. For periods that lack an LP report, (iv) a straight-line interpolation calculation is used to populate the missing data; interpolated data is used for approximately 10% of reporting periods, a figure that has been steadily declining.

Beginning with PitchBook Benchmarks featuring data as of Q4 2019, we expanded our dataset to include funds with a reported IRR, even if the fund's cash flow data does not meet the pooled calculation criteria. In our Q2 2021 report, we made additional improvements to the inclusion criteria for reported IRRs, which caused some shifts in vintage year data counts compared with prior iterations.

Due to lag in reporting for some funds and liquidation causing older funds to no longer report returns, we pull forward cash multiples and IRR information from previous quarters under the following stipulations: (i) We extend cash multiples and IRR after five years since fund inception if reported NAV was less than 5% of commitments. (ii) If NAV is unknown or is greater than 5% after five years, we extend cash multiples and IRR if the fund is older than eight years as of the last known data. (iii) For funds less than five years or are less than eight years with NAV greater than 5%, we extend cash multiples and IRRs from the prior quarter if available.

We strive to maintain consistency from edition to edition of our benchmarking and fund performance reports, but fund classifications will change occasionally, and new funds will be incorporated into the dataset as we gather more information.

All returns data is net of fees and carry.

Definitions and calculation methodologies

Fund count: Represents how many funds are included in a given sample. Note that some funds in our dataset have a reported IRR but lack sufficient cash flow information to be included in pooled calculations.

Median calculations: Shows the middle data point for a sample group.

Public market index returns: Instances where the return of a public market index is cited, we have calculated the annualized return for the given period. All public indices are total return and denominated in US dollars.

Standard deviation: Calculates the dispersion of reported IRRs for a given peer group using the sample-based standard deviation methodology.

Vintage year: Vintage year is the year in which a fund makes its first investment by delivering capital to a project or company. When we cannot confirm the year of first investment, the year of the fund's final close is used as the vintage year.

Internal rate of return (IRR): IRR represents the rate at which a historical series of cash flows are discounted so that the net present value of the cash flows equals zero. For pooled calculations, any remaining unrealized value in the fund is treated as a distribution in the most recent reporting period. This explains why some vintages show high IRRs but low DPI values.

Horizon IRR: Horizon IRR is a capital-weighted pooled calculation that shows the IRR for a certain range in time. For example, the one-year horizon IRR figures in the report may show the IRR performance for the one-year period beginning in Q2 20x0 through the end of Q1 20x1, while the three-year horizon IRR is for the period beginning in Q2 20x0 through the end of Q1 20x3.

Quarterly return: Calculated as the aggregate percentage change in aggregate NAV for each group of funds in a sample, considering contributions and distributions during the quarter. This makes the calculation tantamount to a quarterly compounded growth rate. Interpolated and extended data are not used in this calculation. Preliminary data is only available for the Global Benchmarks report and

will be published when NAV captured nears 50% of the expected NAV for all private capital funds with cash flow history.

Distributions to paid-in (DPI) multiple: A measurement of the capital that has been distributed back to LPs as a proportion of the total paid-in, or contributed, capital. DPI is also known as the cash-on-cash multiple or the realization multiple.

Remaining value to paid-in (RVPI) multiple: A measurement of the unrealized return of a fund as a proportion of the total paid-in, or contributed, capital.

Total value to paid-in (TVPI) multiple: A measurement of both the realized and unrealized value of a fund as a proportion of the total paid-in, or contributed, capital. Also known as the investment multiple, TVPI can be found by adding together the DPI and RVPI of a fund.

Pooled calculations: Pooled calculations combine cashflow data from a group of funds to create a capital-weighted IRR value. All cash flows and NAVs for each fund in the sample group (e.g. all private capital funds, 2004 vintage VC funds, etc.) are aggregated in the calculation. For vintage-specific calculations, we begin the calculation in Q1 of the vintage year, regardless of which quarter a fund first called capital. In cases where the sample has unrealized value, the ending NAV is treated as a cash outflow in the last reporting period.

Equal-weighted pooled calculations: Using the same methodology as the pooled calculations, the equal-weighted version expresses each fund's cash flows and ending NAV as a ratio of fund size. The result is that each fund in these calculations has an equal impact on the output, regardless of the fund size.

Public market equivalent (PME) calculations: PME metrics benchmark the performance of a fund (or group of funds) against an index. A white paper detailing the calculations and methodology behind the PME benchmarks can be found at [pitchbook.com](https://pitchbook.com/resources/whitepapers/public-market-equivalent-benchmarks). PitchBook News & Analysis also contains several articles with PME benchmarks and analysis. All PME figures are calculated using the Kaplan-Schoar PME method: When using a KS-PME, a value greater than 1.0 implies outperformance of the fund over the public index (net of all fees).

PitchBook Private Capital Indexes: PitchBook Private Capital Indexes are a series of indexes available to benchmark quarterly private fund performance. These indexes are built by calculating the change in NAV of active funds in a given quarter, plus/minus aggregate cash flows for the cohort of funds included. Linking the quarterly returns together allows us to construct an index, providing a useful comparison with other portfolio holdings like public markets.

Fundraising

Geographical scope: Fund location is determined by the location of the fund rather than investor headquarters, unless fund location is not known. For US-focused reports, only funds located in the US are included in the fundraising numbers. The same principle applies for EMEA- and APAC-focused reports.

Fundraising activity: Fundraising figures are based on the date of the final close, with interim closes excluded and the entirety of the fund's committed capital attributed to the quarter of the

final close of the fund. Only closed-end vehicles are included in fundraising figures, with capital raised by evergreen or open-ended funds excluded from the dataset. Mega-funds are classified as those that are over 5 billion USD or EUR in size in PE, real estate, real assets, private debt and fund-of-funds.

Private equity: Unless otherwise noted, PE fund data includes buyout, diversified PE, growth and restructuring/turnaround funds. PitchBook defines middle-market funds as PE investment vehicles with between 100 million and 5 billion USD or EUR in capital commitments.

Venture capital: We define VC funds as pools of capital raised for the purpose of investing in the equity of startup companies. In addition to funds raised by traditional VC firms, PitchBook also includes funds raised by any institution with the primary intent stated above. Funds identifying as growth-stage vehicles are classified as PE funds and are not included.

Real estate: We define real estate funds as pools of capital raised for the purpose of investing in the equity of properties that currently have or are intended to have tenants. Funds using core, core plus, value-add, distressed and opportunistic strategies are included in real estate fundraising data.

Real assets: We define real assets funds as pools of capital raised for the purpose of investing in the equity of infrastructure, oil & gas, timber, metals and mining, agriculture and other natural resource assets. Infrastructure funds are categorized by strategy in the fundraising data, divided into infrastructure core, core plus, value-added, opportunistic and greenfield strategies.

Private debt: We define private debt funds as pools of capital raised for the purpose of lending to private companies, including those held by PE funds, VC funds (referred to as ‘venture debt’), real estate funds (referred to as ‘real estate debt’) and infrastructure funds (referred to as ‘infrastructure debt’). These different types of debt funds are consolidated into the private debt category for our fundraising reports, but in asset class reports such as the Global Real Estate Report and Global Real Assets Reports, the related type of private debt is included in fundraising figures (i.e., real estate debt in the Global Real Estate Report and infrastructure debt in the Global Real Assets Report).

Fund of funds: Funds of funds (FoF) are defined as pools of capital raised to invest in several different funds rather than into individual assets or companies. FoF managers are unique in that they act as a GP for the LPs investing into their own fund while playing the role of an LP in the funds in which they invest. While some FoF managers and funds invest opportunistically across asset classes and geographies, some dedicate funds to specific asset classes, such as real estate, or specific geographies.

Secondaries: Secondary funds are defined as pools of capital raised to acquire existing LP interests in funds or stakes in GP-backed companies. While many secondary managers and funds invest opportunistically across asset classes and geographies, some dedicate funds to specific secondaries strategies, such as real estate, infrastructure or private debt, or specific geographies.

Private equity transactions

Geographical scope: Transactions are based on where companies are headquartered. For US-focused reports, only transactions involving companies headquartered in the US are included. The

same principle applies for EMEA or APAC-focused reports. PE buyers/investors/exiters may hail from any region.

Deal timing and inclusion: We include both announced and completed deals when reporting total deal activity for any given period. Additionally, we use announced dates in favor of completed dates for deal timing purposes. We do this to reduce the lag time between when deals are negotiated and priced and when they close to provide a more accurate depiction of valuation trends and volume activity. This approach applies to PE deals and M&A deals only and not to venture-related deals, which use closing dates for recording purposes.

Deal and exit value: Deal value is defined as the total amount of equity and debt used in the PE investment. PitchBook's total deal value figures include deal amounts that were not collected by PitchBook but have been extrapolated using a multivariable regression model. These extrapolated deal amounts are then applied to deals and exits with undisclosed values. Additionally, extrapolated deal amounts are applied to the expected count of late reporting deals and exits (see "Deal and exit count estimation" below). Regardless of the extrapolated deal value, deals are subsequently distributed into size buckets below 1 billion USD or EUR, based on the corresponding proportion of known deal sizes and deal flow capture estimation rates. Some datasets will include these extrapolated numbers, while others will be compiled using only data collected directly by PitchBook; this explains any potential discrepancies.

Deal and exit count estimation: Due to the nature of private market data, information often does not become available until well after a transaction takes place. To provide the most accurate data possible, we estimate how much of this new information will become available in the next four quarters by calculating the average percentage change in deal count over the trailing 24 months observed four quarters after the initial reporting cycle. We then add this estimate to the reported figure for the most recent four quarters. Both the original reported figure and the estimated figure are provided for the reader's reference.

Middle market definition: The middle market (MM) is defined as US-based companies acquired through buyout transactions between 25 million and 1 billion USD. We do not include minority deals. The middle market is further broken down into the lower middle market (LMM; 25 million to 100 million USD), the core middle market (CMM; 100 million to 500 million USD) and the upper middle market (UMM; 500 million to 1 billion USD). The lower bound of each range is inclusive of deals that are that exact amount. For example, a transaction that is 100 million USD in size will be bucketed into the CMM rather than the LMM. We cover only US-based middle-market companies that have undergone a buyout. We exclude add-ons by PE-backed companies that have received PE growth (minority) investments but have not been bought out because we aim to focus on traditional middle-market dealmaking among mature, small-to-midsized companies. Middle market definitions differ for the loan market.

Exits: We define exits as any sale of a PE-backed company that results in a change in majority ownership or listing on a public exchange. Public listings include IPOs and reverse mergers. For the purpose of reporting aggregate exit activity, we use the completion date for IPOs and the announced date for buyouts, M&A and reverse mergers. PitchBook only tracks announced or completed exits, not rumored transactions. Exit value, like deal value, includes exit amounts that were not collected by PitchBook but have been extrapolated using a multivariable regression model.

Regardless of the extrapolated exit value, exits of unknown size are subsequently distributed into deal size buckets below 1 billion USD or EUR, based on the corresponding proportion of known deal sizes and exit activity capture estimation rates. Unless otherwise noted, initial public offering (IPO) sizes are based on the pre-money valuation of the company at the time of IPO. We exclude exits in which the only PE backing was a PIPE. For the MM company inventory, we include companies that are expected to have been exited between 25 million and 1 billion USD or EUR.

Venture capital transactions

Geographical scope: Transactions are based on where companies are headquartered. For US-focused reports, only transactions involving companies headquartered in the US are included. The same principle applies for EMEA or APAC-focused reports. VC buyers/investors/exiters may hail from any region. “Ecosystem” in our US-focused reports is defined as the combined statistical area (CSA).

Deal timing and inclusion: We include equity investments in startup companies from an external source. Investment does not necessarily have to be taken from an institutional investor. This can include investment from individual angel investors, angel groups, seed and venture funds, CVCs, and corporations, among others. Investments received as part of an accelerator program are not included. However, if the accelerator continues to invest in follow-on rounds, those additional financings are included. Equity deals are included, as well as those that are a mix of debt and equity. Full-debt transactions are included in venture debt datasets but are not included in VC activity datasets.

- **Pre-seed:** The pre-seed stage encompasses a collection of emergent startups receiving the first check from at least one institutional investor to fuel their development growth. For global startups, we reclassify angel deals depending on institutional investors' prior deal participation. Deals that have been tagged as "angel" due to the company's investor base consisting solely of individual investors are categorized into the early-stage or late-stage VC deal category based on stage methodologies in place. For startups headquartered in the US and Europe, we define pre-seed as a round of financing for a company founded less than two years ago that has not yet received institutional investor support.
- **Seed:** We classify a deal as seed if it is explicitly labeled so per a reliable source. Using Form D as a source, we will also classify a deal as seed when a company does not have prior VC rounds, does not have VC board members, and the round amount is between 1 million and 10 million USD or EUR. Pre-seed and pre-Series A deals are built as seed rounds when the company does not have prior VC backing. Otherwise, these deals will be built as early-stage or late-stage rounds.
- **Early stage:** For a deal to be classified as early-stage VC, the company must be founded fewer than five years by the time of the deal, and if a series is specified, it should be a Series A or B.
- **Late stage:** For a deal to be classified as late-stage VC, the company must be five years old or older regardless of series. Alternatively, if a series is specified, it should be a Series C or later regardless of time since founded.
- **Venture growth:** Rounds are generally classified as Series E or later (which we typically aggregate together as venture growth) either by the series of stock issued in the financing or, if that information is unavailable, by a series of factors, including the age of the company, number of VC rounds, company status and participating investors.
- **Venture debt:** The venture debt dataset is inclusive of most debt products raised by VC-backed companies, regardless of the stage of the company. We exclude bridge and convertible notes. In mixed equity and debt transactions, equity is excluded when the amount is of known value. Financings that are solely debt are included in this dataset, though not incorporated into the deal activity dataset used throughout the report. Mixed equity and debt transactions will be included in both datasets.
- **Nontraditional investors:** We define nontraditional investors as any investor that is not classified primarily as a traditional VC firm. "CVC" includes rounds executed by established CVC arms as well as direct equity investments by corporations into VC-backed companies. "PE" includes VC deals by investors whose primary classification is PE/buyout, growth, mezzanine or other PE. "Crossover" investors are a subset of nontraditional investors—specifically asset managers, hedge funds, mutual funds, family offices and sovereign wealth funds—that have been active in VC investment across any stage. They are referred to as crossover investors because they are likely to be participating at the late stages directly prior to an exit.

Deal count estimation: Estimated deal count represents the number of deals that we estimate will be collected during the four quarters following the report release. With a natural lag in the collection of data in the private market, the number of deals that are closed in a quarter change as our Data Operations team picks up more deals. We estimate deal count by looking at historic data, specifically how much quarterly deal count changes after our report gets published. Historic deal counts are updated each quarter.

Exits: We include the first majority liquidity event for holders of equity securities of venture-backed companies. This includes events where there is a public market for the shares (IPO) or the acquisition of the majority of the equity by another entity (corporate or financial acquisition). This

does not include secondary sales, further sales after the initial liquidity event or bankruptcies. M&A value is based on reported or disclosed figures, with no estimation used to assess the value of transactions for which the actual deal size is unknown. IPO value is based on the pre-money valuation of the company at its IPO price. Our methodology reflects a categorical change from “IPO” to “public listings” to accommodate the different ways we track VC-backed companies’ transitions to the public markets. To give readers a fuller picture of the companies that go public, this updated grouping includes IPOs, direct listings, and reverse mergers via SPACs.

Unicorns: PitchBook defines a unicorn as a venture-backed company that has raised a venture round bequeathing a post-money valuation of at least 1 billion USD or EUR. In the investor league tables related to stage and series, the count of unicorns by investor tracks all unicorns, not merely active unicorns. For example, having invested in three unicorns, two of which have since gone public, would still credit an investor with three in that tally. Underlying datasets of unicorn inventory and deal flow include past unicorns, due to the need for such data to reflect historical performance.

M&A

Geographical scope: Transactions are based on where companies are headquartered. Buyers/investors/exiters may hail from any region.

Definition: M&A is defined as the substantive transfer of control or ownership. We track only announced or completed control transactions. Eligible transaction types include control acquisitions, leveraged buyouts (including asset acquisitions), corporate divestitures, corporate asset purchases, spinoffs and asset divestitures. We exclude reverse mergers, which we consider to be a form of public listing. Debt restructuring or any other liquidity, self-tenders (in which a company undertakes an offer for a typically limited number of its own shares to ward off a hostile takeover), or internal reorganizations are not included. Rumored or canceled deals are not included. Aggregate transaction value is not extrapolated using known deal values, unless otherwise noted as estimated.

Deal timing and inclusion: We include both announced and completed deals when reporting total deal activity for any given period. Additionally, we use announced dates in favor of completed dates for deal timing purposes. We do this to reduce the lag time between when deals are negotiated and priced and when they close to provide a more accurate depiction of valuation trends and volume activity. This approach applies to PE deals and M&A deals only and not to venture-related deals, which use closing dates for recording purposes. Corporate asset purchases were not considered an eligible transaction type until Q2 2017. As such, some historical deal flow figures will have shifted beginning at this time.

Deal and exit value: Deal value is defined as the total amount of equity and debt used in the transaction. PitchBook’s total deal value figures include deal amounts that were not collected by PitchBook but have been extrapolated using a multidimensional estimation matrix. Some datasets will include these extrapolated numbers, while others will be compiled using only data collected directly by PitchBook; this explains any potential discrepancies.

Deal and exit count estimation: Due to the nature of private market data, information often does not become available until well after a transaction takes place. To provide the most accurate data possible, we estimate how much of this new information will become available in the next four quarters by calculating the average percentage change in deal count over the trailing 24 months observed four quarters after the initial reporting cycle. We then add this estimate to the reported figure for the most recent four quarters. Both the original reported figure and the estimated figure are provided for the reader's reference.

Global League Tables

All league tables are compiled using the count of completed deals for the specified deal type, region and/or other criteria. Only publicly disclosed transactions are included.

Private equity: The report includes all PE investments (buyouts as tracked by PitchBook, growth and investor buyouts by management) but excludes real estate investments. Only investments made directly by PE investors or their portfolio companies are counted. Buyout deals are defined as transactions in which the PE investor receives a controlling ownership stake in the target company. Growth deals are defined as minority investments. Add-on deals are defined as acquisitions by companies with PE backing.

Venture capital: The Global League Tables includes all traditional VC investment/round types defined by PitchBook (including angel/seed). No corporate, accelerator, incubator, crowdfunding, real estate, debt restructuring, or dividend recapitalizations are included. The rankings do not exclude based on investor type. For example, if a round is classified as early-stage VC but accelerators or incubators are listed as participants, that would be included, as rankings are based on round types only. As our league tables are based on round classifications, they include financings by investors such as corporate VC arms. However, if a corporate VC has a majority stake, it would be considered an M&A deal.

M&A: Eligible transaction types include control acquisitions, leveraged buyouts (including asset acquisitions solely for LBOs), reverse mergers and spin-offs. The full span of eligible deal types is comprised of control acquisitions, leveraged buyouts (including asset acquisitions), corporate divestitures, corporate asset purchases, spinoffs and asset divestitures. Transactions must involve SMEs or corporations and must be a substantive transfer of control or ownership. Debt restructurings or other liquidity, self-tenders or internal reorganizations are not included.

Service providers: Service provider (SP) league tables are compiled using the same criteria for deals as the other league tables. The advisors & accountants rankings only include rankings based on PE deals, along the criteria for PE transactions used above. Before October 2023, except for tables distinguished by entity type serviced (company or investor), transactions were not counted twice, meaning if the SP provided the same service to both the investor and company on one deal, it would only receive credit for one deal in the rankings, not two. However, as of October 2023, transactions now may count twice if an SP performed a different service in that same transaction.

Advisors are no longer limited by firm type as of October 2023 as well, with all advisor types consolidated as need be. For example, an advisory firm classified as a tax advisor in the PitchBook

Platform that is listed as providing legal services due to it being a multiservice firm in a given transaction could be considered eligible toward a legal advisor ranking table.

In 2023, placement agents were debuted as a separate ranking based on closed, fully invested or liquidated funds. Other criteria for placement agents' rankings included:

- The fund type must be angel, co-investment, debt, fund-of-funds, other, PE, real assets, real estate, secondaries and VC.
- Each fund must have an associated investor.
- The placement agent must be associated to a fund.

Ineligible criteria for placement agents' rankings included

- Funds that are closed, evergreen or liquidated outside of the quarter in question
- Unclassified funds
- Funds without a status
- Funds without a currency code

Starting with the 2024 Annual Global League Tables, any ties in the Placement Agent ranking will be resolved by considering the total dollar amount of their closed, fully invested, or liquidated funds.

Exits: Exit league tables consider both full and partial exits via corporate acquisition, secondary PE buyout, buyout by PE firm and IPO. Dividend recapitalizations are not considered in the report.

Industries & sectors: Companies tracked by PitchBook have a primary industry, as well as secondary industries. For this report, the primary industry was used to determine rankings by industry and sector.

PE Lending League Tables

Notes: In the PE Lending League Tables, the scope is restricted to lending to Europe and US-headquartered companies in PE transactions and transactions involving PE or formerly PE-backed companies only. In addition, we utilized current financing statuses to help define the scope, restricting all relevant businesses to status tags of PE-backed, PE-backed with an incomplete transaction and formerly PE-backed (the last in order to accommodate businesses that, in the course of an M&A transaction with a PE-backed enterprise, saw a lender's involvement). All league tables are compiled using the count of completed deals for the specified deal type, region and/or other criteria.

Private equity deals: The report includes select types of PE investments, aside from real estate investments. Only investments made directly by PE investors or their portfolio companies are counted. Buyout deals are defined as transactions in which the PE investor receives a controlling ownership stake in the target company. Secondary buyouts are defined as when a PE investor receives a controlling ownership stake in a target company that is already backed by a PE investor. Add-on deals are defined as acquisitions by companies with PE backing.

Lenders: Lender league tables look at completed PE deals the lender provided debt financing for in a given time period or region. In league tables for debt-only financings, the transaction must involve

debt financing to a company that is PE-backed.

Debt types: The report includes select debt types as tracked by PitchBook, limited to general debt, senior debt and revolvers in this edition, as long as they were used in conjunction with a leveraged buyout or add-on. General debt tables include all debt types, as long as the transaction occurred with a PE-backed company. The tables of senior debt and revolvers are restricted to only those specific debt types as tracked by PitchBook.

Industries & sectors: Companies tracked by PitchBook have a primary industry, as well as secondary industries. For this report, the primary industry was used to determine rankings by industry and sector.



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Benchmarks

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